Experiment 8: User Management & RBAC in Zoho Creator

Aim

To configure User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in the Insurance Claim application built on Zoho Creator, so that each user tier gets only the permissions and record visibility its role needs.

Workflow

Role-Based Access Control restricts system access based on the organizational role of a user. In this lab, the Insurance Claim application (forms: Customer Details, Insurance Policy, Insurance Claim) is configured with three user tiers arranged in a role hierarchy, with the CEO at the top and the Manager and Standard Employee roles reporting beneath it.

Role Name	Assigned Permissions	Data Access Scope
CEO (Administrator)	Full Create, Read, Update, Delete (CRUD)	All records across the organization
Manager	Read, Update, Approve claim records	Own records and records of subordinate roles
Standard Employee	Create and Read own submissions	Only self-created records

Procedure

1. **Access Developer Mode:** Log into Zoho Creator, open the Insurance Claim1 application and click the Settings (gear) icon in the top builder menu.
2. **Open User Permissions:** On the Settings page, under the Permissions section, click User Permissions. The Users page opens with the Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing tabs.
3. **Configure Roles:** Select the Roles tab and click Add Role to create the custom roles Manager and Standard Employee beneath the default CEO role. Use Manage Role Hierarchy to set the reporting lines, then use Expand All to confirm the tree: CEO > Manager and Standard Employee.
4. **Define Permissions and Data Sharing:** Use the Permissions tab to set module-level rights (form access, report viewing, edit and delete rights) for each profile, and the Data Sharing tab to define record visibility for each role.
5. **Review the Claim Workflow:** Open the Workflow tab and select the Insurance Claim form under Forms with workflows. The Claim Submission Workflow runs on successful form submission and is shown as Enabled.
6. **Add a Role Check with Deluge:** In the Functions tab, create the function `check_user_role` using the Deluge editor and click Save, then Execute to test it.

```
void check_user_role()
{
    if (zoho.adminuser)
    {
        info "User is Admin";
    }
    else
    {
        info "User role checked";
    }
}
```

The function prints "User is Admin" when the logged-in user is the application administrator, and "User role checked" for every other role.

Screenshots

Figure 1: Settings page of the Insurance Claim1 application (Permissions, Personalization and Developer Tools)

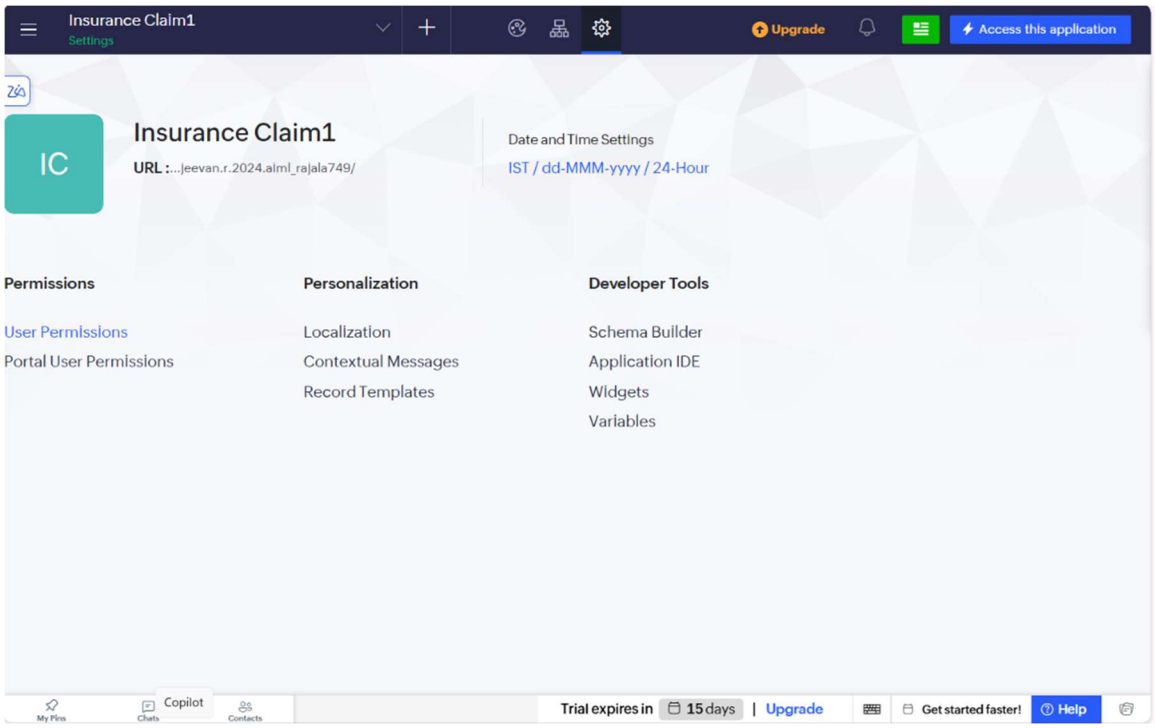


Figure 2: User Permissions > Roles tab showing the role hierarchy (CEO, Manager, Standard Employee)

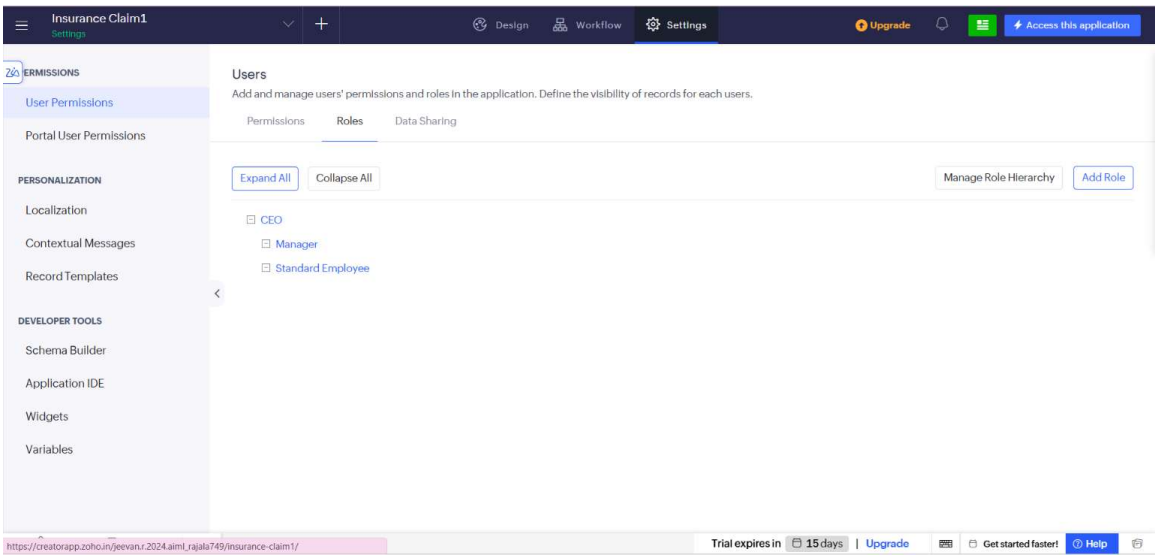


Figure 3: Workflow tab showing the enabled Claim Submission Workflow on the Insurance Claim form

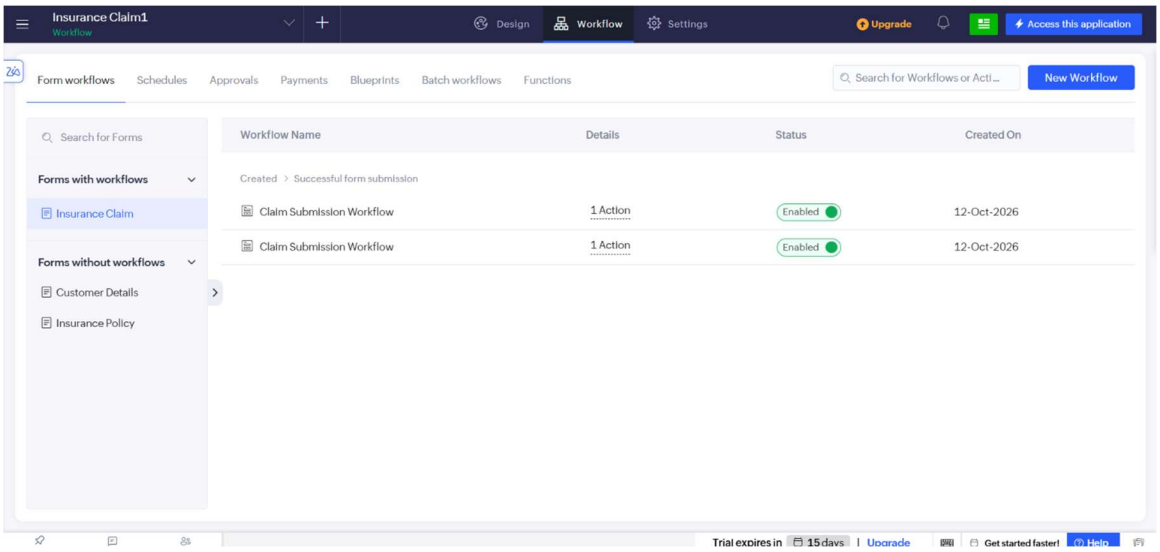
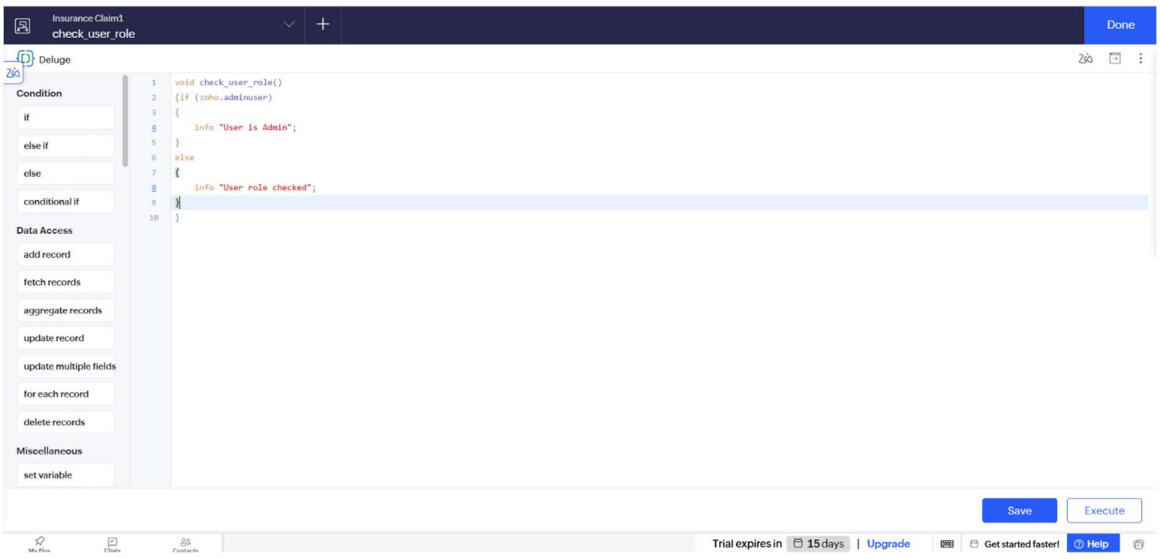


Figure 4: Deluge function check_user_role for the role check



Result

User management and RBAC rules were successfully configured and tested in the Insurance Claim application in Zoho Creator, ensuring robust application security, data isolation, and structured multi-user workflow execution.